

The Program in Action

When you run *clickbait.py*, the output will look like this:

Clickbait Headline Generator

By Al Sweigart al@inventwithpython.com

Our website needs to trick people into looking at ads!

Enter the number of clickbait headlines to generate:

> 1000

Big Companies Hate Him! See How This New York Cat Invented a Cheaper Robot

What Telephone Psychics Don't Want You To Know About Avocados

You Won't Believe What This North Carolina Shovel Found in Her Workplace

--snip--

14 Reasons Why Parents Are More Interesting Than You Think (Number 1 Will Surprise You!)

What Robots Don't Want You To Know About Cats

This Florida Telephone Psychic Didn't Think Robots Would Take Her Job. She Was Wrong.

How It Works

This program has several functions for generating different kinds of clickbait headlines. Each of them gets random words from STATES, NOUNS, PLACES, WHEN, and other lists. The functions then insert these words into a template string with the `format()` string method before returning this string. This is like a “Mad Libs” activity book, except the computer fills in the blanks, allowing the program to generate thousands of clickbait headlines in seconds.

```
1. """Clickbait Headline Generator, by Al Sweigart al@inventwithpython.com
2. A clickbait headline generator for your soulless content farm website.
3. View this code at https://nostarch.com/big-book-small-python-projects
4. Tags: large, beginner, humor, word"""
5.
6. import random
7.
8. # Set up the constants:
9. OBJECT_PRONOUNS = ['Her', 'Him', 'Them']
10. POSSESSIVE_PRONOUNS = ['Her', 'His', 'Their']
11. PERSONAL_PRONOUNS = ['She', 'He', 'They']
12. STATES = ['California', 'Texas', 'Florida', 'New York', 'Pennsylvania',
13.           'Illinois', 'Ohio', 'Georgia', 'North Carolina', 'Michigan']
14. NOUNS = ['Athlete', 'Clown', 'Shovel', 'Paleo Diet', 'Doctor', 'Parent',
15.          'Cat', 'Dog', 'Chicken', 'Robot', 'Video Game', 'Avocado',
16.          'Plastic Straw', 'Serial Killer', 'Telephone Psychic']
17. PLACES = ['House', 'Attic', 'Bank Deposit Box', 'School', 'Basement',
18.           'Workplace', 'Donut Shop', 'Apocalypse Bunker']
19. WHEN = ['Soon', 'This Year', 'Later Today', 'RIGHT NOW', 'Next Week']
20.
21.
22. def main():
23.     print('Clickbait Headline Generator')
24.     print('By Al Sweigart al@inventwithpython.com')
```